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COMMUNITY CORNER PESACH EDITION



YOM TOV STARTS:

7:03 PM
(18 MINUTES)

SHABBOS ENDS:

8:14 PM
(50 MINUTES)

TZAIS HAKOCHAVIM:

8:35 PM
(72 MINUTES)

Editor-in-chief: Doni Stern

Made possible by contributing writers throughout our community.



STORY OF THE WEEK By: Zechariah Lipitz



The customs of the seder night are ancient and profound. For example, the mnemonic device which has been taught for a thousand years to help remember parts of the seder. It begins: "Kadesh, urchatz...etc.," and means "Recite the Kiddush on the hands..." etc. It has been the custom over the many generations for teachers to instill these words in the minds of their tiniest students, who then recite them on the seder night, explaining each of them in the Yiddish vernacular.

The first word, "kadesh" is explained, "When Father comes home from shul on the evening of Passover, he must say the kiddush right away so that the little children don't fall asleep without saying the Four Questions, beginning 'Mah Nishtana.'"

It so happened one year in the home of Rebbe Aryeh Leib of Shpole (known as the Shpole Zeide) that his small son began the recitation with the word "kadesh" and proceeded with the Yiddish explanation, saying, "When Father comes home from shul (synagogue) on Passover night, he must recite the kiddush immediately." His explanation, however, went no further, and his father asked, "Why don't you continue?"

"My teacher didn't tell me anything else to say," replied the child.

The Shpole Zeide then proceeded to tell his son the rest of the explanation, which continued: "...so that the little children won't fall asleep and will ask the Four Questions beginning with 'Why is this night different from all other nights?'"

On the second night of Passover the boy's teacher was among the guests at the Shpole Zeide's table, and the tzadik asked him, "Why didn't you teach the children the rest of the explanation of the word 'kadesh?'"

"Oh," he replied, "I didn't think it was so important for a little child to know. Anyway, that's not the most important part of the explanation."

The Shpole Zeide was upset by this reply, and said, "How do you dare to take it upon yourself to alter the venerable customs of our illustrious ancestors? You simply don't understand the depth and profundity of this teaching. Listen, and I will explain the inner meaning of those words:

"The words 'recite kiddush and wash the hands,' these are the introduction to the whole seder. In the holy Zohar it is written that Rabbi Chiya opened up his discourse with the words from the Song of Songs 'I am asleep, but my heart is awake,' meaning 'I am asleep during the Exile.' During the long Exile the Jews are as if asleep, lacking the heights of spiritual sensitivity.

"The true meaning of the children's words, 'When Father comes home from shul on Passover night', is 'When our Father in Heaven returns to His Abode on High and He sees that all the Jews - no matter how exhausted from their preparations for the holiday - all go to pray and give thanks to Him,' then: 'He must recite kiddush right away,' which is to say, G-d must renew His vows of betrothal to His deserted bride, the Jewish People, as it says in the prophet Hosea: 'And I will betroth you to me forever.'

"And what is the reason He must do this with haste? That is explained, 'So that the little children won't fall asleep.' The prophets often refer to the Jewish people as the small, precious children of G-d. The Alm-ghy must act immediately to redeem His people, lest the deep sleep of the Exile totally overwhelm them (G-d forbid), and they cannot be awakened, so that the Redemption would be impossible. "The end of the phrase, 'So that they will ask the question 'Mah nistana...' Why is this night different from all other nights?' is explained as follows: We ask, 'Why is this terrible, dark Exile longer than all the other exiles we have previously endured?'"

As he uttered these words the Shpole Zeide couldn't contain his emotions and he burst into bitter tears.

"Our Father in Heaven, redeem us quickly from the exile while we're only in a kind of half sleep and our hearts still remain awake! Don't wait until we fall into a sleep so deep that we cannot be awakened!"

Everyone who witnessed this scene was shaken to his core with the desire for repentance, many weeping from the depths of their souls.

The Rebbe then abruptly interrupted this sad mood saying, "Kinderlach, children, let's have some liveliness and give our Father a little 'nachas.' Let's show Him that His little children can dance and be joyful even in this deep darkness!" And with that, the tzadik began to whirl and turn in a dance of spiritual rapture.

B'KITZUR By: Daniel Moskovits



Hilchos Seder night

An attendant of the one conducting the Seder or a family member should fill the cups. Likewise, each time we fill the cups, others should fill it and not the leader himself. This is to show freedom.

Short Halacha from this week's Kitzur Shulchan Aruch Yomi - Chapter 119 Se'if 2

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PARSHA QUESTION By: Gavriel Grodtko

Where lies the difference between the question of the chuchum and the question of the rasha?
Stay tuned for the answer in the next Community Corner issue

Answer to last weeks parsha question:

Q. We had to leave home and camp out for 7 days outside the Ohel Moed.
Who are we? Hint can be found in יבנינו
A. Aaron and his sons

PESACH DVAR TORAH

By: Rabbi Zev Fuchs

Preparing for Pesach takes a lot of effort, even more than many other Mitzvos combined! For weeks, we clean and check every place where there might be even the tiniest bit of Chametz. Our desks at school, backpacks, drawers, and closets are all carefully cleaned to make sure they are completely chametz-free. After we finish Bedikas Chametz, we do Bitul Chametz, saying that any chametz we may have missed is worthless. The next day, we do Biur Chametz and sell any remaining chametz to a non-Jew. But this leads to a big question: If in the end we say that any Chametz we have is worthless and we sell the rest, why do we spend so much time cleaning and checking? Why not just skip the cleaning and sell everything? The answer is something very important. Chazal teach us that Chametz represents the Yetzer Hara, the part inside us that tries to pull us in the wrong direction and gets in the way of our connection to Hashem. It convinces us to do things that we aren't proud of. Imagine you worked for weeks on a beautiful painting. It shows a bright sunny sky, green grass, trees, and a horse peacefully grazing. You're so proud of it and can't wait to show your parents. But when you finally bring them to see it, you notice that your younger sibling scribbled a small pen mark across the sky! Even though it's just a tiny mark, it ruins the whole picture, and you feel so upset. Your Neshama is like that beautiful painting - it shines bright and pure with Kedusha. Throughout the year, when we do Aveiros, our Neshama gets covered in black marks. It's like adding little smudge marks to that beautiful picture. When we clean for Pesach, we're not just cleaning our homes, we're also "cleaning" our Neshamas. Just like we search carefully for every crumb of Chametz, we can try to remove the "marks" that the Yetzer Hara leaves on us. By the time we reach the Seder night, even though we may be tired from all the cleaning, we are ready to relive Yetziyas Mitzrayim. Not just being freed from Paroh, but also becoming free from the Yetzer Hara. Always remember: your Neshama is like a shining diamond. Even if it gets a little dirty, you can always polish it and let it shine again!

NOACH'S JOKES & RIDDLES By: Noach Isaacs

What is the opposite of lady fingers?

ANSWER: MENTOS



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The main section of the Passover Haggadah, known as Maggid, in which we tell the story of our miraculous liberation from slavery, is capped off by a song, sung to a tune that is known and loved in virtually every Jewish home: Dayenu. This song is comprised of fifteen stanzas, in which we enumerate the miracles that brought us from the house of bondage to our homeland—God's acts of kindness that we might not have expected or even deserved. As we mention each new step, each wondrous stage in the process of our emancipation, we say "dayenu!": Had God not performed this additional miracle, we would have been satisfied with everything else. He had already done for us. Each new miracle would have been, on its own, sufficient reason for us to give thanks.

Adam and Eve eat from the fruit of the Tree of Knowledge of Good and Evil, the one and only tree God had expressly placed off limits. God conducts an inquiry, as it were; He asks Adam to explain his behavior. Rather than admitting his guilt or taking responsibility for his transgression, Adam blames his wife—and, by extension, God Himself.

Bereishit 3:12

This gives us quite a lot to think about in terms of the Passover Seder: The Seder allows us to relive the end of the Egyptian exile, one of the most bitter exiles in the long history of Jewish wandering. Each year, as we identify with the Exodus, as we retell and commemorate the events of the Exodus, we, too, sing songs of praise and thanksgiving. The core of the Maggid section is made up of midrashic teachings that expound upon the biblical passage known as Arami Oved Avi. These same verses are recited during the Festival of Bikkurim; Rashi (Devarim 26:5) tells us that these verses, recited as we bring the first fruits up to the Holy Temple, are an expression of our joy and gratitude for all the good God has given us. With the bounty of the Holy Land in hand, we recite this particular text, which places our joy into historical, national and religious perspective. We offer thanks to God—for His kindness, and for fulfilling the covenant He made with our forefathers.

In his commentary on the Haggadah, the Gaon of Vilna teaches that the fifteen stanzas of Dayenu are parallel to the fifteen steps of the Beit HaMikdash that connected the Ezrat Nashim to the Ezrat Yisra'el. As the Levites ascended these stairs, they sang the fifteen Songs of Ascent, songs of praise and thanksgiving to God. Dayenu, then, is both a lesson in the importance of appreciation and an experience of joy. As we sit at the Seder, perhaps our singing should parallel that of the Levi'im on the steps of Holy Temple. As we acknowledge each of the miracles and acts of kindness God performed for us, Dayenu's final stanza connects us to the Beit HaMikdash and to its joyous song, enabling us to take

A horizontal strip of three nature photographs. The left photo shows a small waterfall cascading over rocks in a forest. The middle photo is a close-up of a pink flower with a yellow center. The right photo shows a yellow bird with black wings perched on a branch with pink blossoms.

Weekly Q&A with Dr. Shari Hirsch,
Pediatrician and Lactation Specialist at Lev Pediatric Care

WEEK 16

"How can I tell if my child has an ear infection, and when are antibiotics really needed?"

Winter brings cozy sweaters and hot chocolate, but it also brings plenty of runny noses. Along with colds and viruses, ear infections become more common this time of year, leaving many parents wondering if antibiotics are needed.

Most ear infections develop after a viral illness. Congestion and swelling can block the eustachian tubes, trapping fluid in the middle ear and creating an environment for infection.

Symptoms vary by age. Babies and toddlers may tug at their ears, become fussier, sleep poorly, develop fever, or feed less. Older children may complain of ear pain, pressure, headache, trouble hearing, or fever.

A true ear infection is diagnosed by looking at the eardrum. Pediatricians check for bulging, redness, and fluid. This distinction matters because fluid alone does not always mean infection.

Antibiotics are sometimes necessary, but not always. They are more likely for young infants, severe symptoms like high fever or significant pain, or if symptoms worsen or do not improve after a few days.

Antibiotics don't treat viruses and won't help ear pain caused by pressure alone. Unnecessary use can cause side effects and contribute to antibiotic resistance. Pain control with acetaminophen or ibuprofen is often the most important first treatment.

Check in if ear pain lasts more than 24 hours, fever is present, symptoms aren't improving, fluid is draining from the ear, or your child is under 6 months old. If your child seems more uncomfortable than usual, trust your instincts.

Ear infections are common and stressful, but most are manageable and resolve without complications. The goal isn't to avoid antibiotics at all costs, but to use them when truly needed. Your pediatrician will help guide that decision.

Send it to Lev Pediatric Care, and Dr. Hirsch may feature it in an upcoming Q and A.

By: Gabriella and Mikayla



It has a super skinny, extra-long middle finger it uses to tap on trees, find bugs, then hook them out like a tool. It's basically nature's built-in fishing rod.

- Echolocation... kinda
It taps on wood and listens for hollow sounds to find insects inside—similar idea to how bats use sound.
- Rodent-style teeth
Even though it's a primate, its teeth never stop growing, like a rat.

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RUN BY: KAYLA STERN

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H	R	O	H	T	M	H	A	Y	R	H	P	U	Y
C	L	H	Z	E	C	D	R	S	A	Z	A	O	I
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K	E	A	R	A	H	A	O	R	R	E	O	A	A
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Illustration of a purple mailbox with a red flag, a yellow envelope, and a white paper airplane.

WESLEY HILLS

The Shul of Pomona Heights, 60 Halley drive (Mickey Schlusser)
Anshei Pishchas, 11 Palisades Court, Pomona (Shlomo Yoblonsky)
Orhei Yavook Shlomo, 43 Tamarrack Lane, Pomona (Yakov Rosenthal)
Kehal Avreichim Pomona, 3 Chestnut Drive, Pomona (Avi Hirsch)
9 Ladentown Road, Pomona (Berry Nash)
15 Woodfield Rd, Pomona (Don Stern)
34 N Ridge Rd, Pomona (Shaya Setton)
Beis Mdrash Torah u Tilaah, 1 Klingler court (Nochum Wilner)
Shaarei Tefillah, New Hempstead
56 mayjer Dr Montebello (Shmuel Ganzc)
The Village Green Shul, 4 Village Green, Wesley Hills (Shlomo Kertznr)
Atreses Rosh 16 Charlotte Drive (Avi Stern)
Kehilas Yeshorim of Wesley Hills 1 Harriet Lane (Yael Megadash)
Cong Ohav Yisroel, 30 Blueberry Hill Road, Monsey (Yossie Becker)
Congregation Ahavat Israel, Suffern
84 Viola Road, Montebello (Yarkich Yankin)
Kehilas Shaar Hashamayim of 71 East Willow Tree Rd (Moshe Brachfeld)

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INTERVIEW WITH ZUSHA

Zusha, the singer-songwriter duo of Shlomo Gaisin and Zachariah Goldschmiedt, has carved out a distinctive voice with hit songs like “Don’t Leave Me On My Own,” “Brighter,” and “Aleph Beis,” each resonating deeply with listeners around the world. Community Corner caught up with them in the midst of recording new music, planning what’s next, and Pesach prep.

What do you feel your mission is in the Jewish music space? What makes you stand out as artists?

S: Our mission? To explore the sounds Hashem placed in this world and conquer new sonic terrain for the Yidden.

The greatest music once flowed through the Beis Hamikdash. When it was destroyed, those holy sparks of sound were exiled and scattered across the globe. We want to bring them back, hunting genres for those good sparks and reclaiming them, song by song, together as shuttafim.

Z: We’re trying to write the kind of music that can inspire someone in the Mir and also someone who’s never put tefillin on before. To me, the mission feels like connecting to people on an essential level where you can have two types of yidden who would never see eye to eye in the same room, finally realizing that they are one family. I grew up listening to all sorts of music, including non-Jewish music, so I want our music to be so good that anyone would be excited to listen- and not just because of the music, but also because of its inspiring messages and the fact that it’s chassidus mamesh.

Is there a Mitzvah or value that inspires your music? What makes a song feel holy or special?

S: The mitzvah of mikvah and the idea that there’s a space you can enter to dream of a deeper, higher, truer self. We create immersive music along those same lines, a sonic space you can enter that helps you dream bigger, envisioning and hoping to draw down into reality a deeper, higher, and truer self. It brings you in and spits you out cleaner and purer than before you heard it. That’s what we are aiming for. What makes a song holy? The preparation before writing. Do you go to the mikvah before you compose or perform? The intention behind its ultimate impact: Is it just for fun? To be heard and understood? For your career or catalog? Or is it to inspire the hearts of Yidden, to draw them closer to Hashem, to their fellow Jew, to themselves? To want to grow in their Yiddishkeit just a little more today than yesterday? That intention and the kavanah when you sing it is what can make a song holy and/or special.

Z: If we want people to feel inspired, uplifted, tranquil and connected, we need to be singing from that place. For me, Shabbos is the time to water the inner garden and tap into yishuv hadaas. With all the craziness of traveling and running around that comes with being a musician, shabbos is really the time to plug back into the charger. Connecting and singing with my family around the Shabbos table really reminds me what the whole point is. The litmus test for me is to look around the table and see, is this music bringing more joy into the world? Is it making me feel closer to Hashem? If I listen to this song, do I want to go do a mitzvah and help another yid? Then I know it’s something special for me and will hopefully be special for others too.

How do you come up with your songs? Which was the hardest to write?

S: There are many ways to write a song, but what’s tried and true for us? Finding what our heart must farbreng. We identify a nekudah we ourselves need to hear- and sing from there. Always keeping it positive. Often, we start with chords- searching for the ones that open our heart in that moment. The right sequence, the right phrasing, tinkering until it “strikes a chord.” From there, we’re on solid ground. We farbreng until the nekudah emerges, a melody arises naturally, and we fill in lyrics that feel true and refreshing to sing to each other, to Hashem, and to the world, all in one package.

Z: We usually try to start with an idea, like what is this song about? What are we trying to talk about today? What has been inspiring us lately? From there we move on to picking up whatever instrument is laying around, sometimes it’s a guitar, a piano or even just a computer. We try not to let the tools get in the way of the core creativity which is just the light looking for a vessel. We’ll just kind of sit, testing out chords, melodies and trying to find the most precise, memorable and impactful way to say the inspiring thing. I think in general the hardest thing is to write something specific enough that you’re actually saying something, and universal enough that it can speak to a lot of people wherever they’re holding.

If you could sing anywhere in the world, where would you go?

S: I would love to sing in the Beis HaMikdash. Every day I long for that opportunity.

Z: It’s been years since we’ve been able to perform in Israel so we are very much looking forward to being able to play for the yidden in Eretz Yisrael.

Do you ever get nervous before you perform? What advice would you give kids who want to sing?

S: I get nervous every time. But that’s good, it means you care about making a real impact. Our Rebbe in Yerushalayim told me: so long as you feel the koved rosh / gravitas before singing, continue. The moment you stop feeling it, stop singing. My advice for those who want to sing? Give a dollar to tzedakah before and after. Learn a page in a sefer beforehand. And say “Hashem Sefasai Tiftach” before you open your mouth to sing. A spoonful of Torah, Mitzvos, and a shtickle Tefilla makes the essence of the Neshama come out in your voice.

Z: Definitely. I think it’s part of the deal. Nervousness and excitement are closely related, so I think it kind of oscillates between feeling excited and a little nervous. Instead of trying to rid yourself of being nervous, try to find a way to enjoy it. It’s okay to feel a little nervous and it would be weird if you weren’t nervous to walk out in front of hundreds or thousands of people and share your inner world. I think the best thing to do if you want to sing is to sing! The more you do it the more you’ll feel comfortable. Don’t wait around for the perfect scenario or until you have zero stage fright. Everyone’s gotta start somewhere, and the sooner you start the sooner you can improve.

Anything else you’d like to share?

S: Hashem believes in you more than you know. Now go crush the klipos holding you back and reveal the primiyus uniquely yours to share.

Z: Hashem is in charge of everything. Hashem runs the world. If one door closes it means another one has opened. There are plenty of times in our career that it felt like something was supposed to happen and it didn’t. Instead of getting disappointed we should just know that Hashem is unlimited in His ability to make things happen. Hashem can send his blessings in many different ways. The main thing is to continue with inner peace because Hashem’s bracha rests in the vessel of peace. When we are continuously thankful and at peace with everything that Hashem has done for us, it allows Hashem to send the REAL BRACHA.



CHOL HAMOED TRIPS

By: Meir Rubin

Local Parks and Nature

- Kakiat Park**
 - Address: 668 Haverstraw Rd, Montebello, NY
 - Time: 13 Minutes
 - Hours: 7 AM – 8 PM
 - Distance: 5 Miles
 - Phone: 845-364-2670
- Kathryn Gorman Ponds Park**
 - Address: 25 Senator Levy Drive, Montebello, NY
 - Time: 10 Minutes
 - Hours: 7 AM – 6 PM
 - Distance: 3.1 Miles

Palisades Mall

- Palisades Climb Adventure**
 - Address: 4590 Palisades Center Dr, West Nyack, NY
 - Time: 18 Minutes
 - Distance: 8.2 miles
 - Hours: Sunday – 11:00 AM – 7:00 PM
 - Monday – Tuesday – Closed Wednesday –
 - Thursday – 2:30 PM – 7:30 PM Friday – 2:00 PM – 9:00 PM
 - Phone: 845-727-3500
- Billy Beez**
 - Address: 1000 Palisades Center Drive, West Nyack, NY
 - Time: 20 Minutes
 - Distance: 8.7 Miles
 - Hours: Sunday – 11:00 AM – 8:00 PM Monday – Friday – 11:00 AM – 6:00 PM
 - Phone: 845-535-9277
- Dave & Buster’s**
 - Address: 4661 Palisades Center Drive, West Nyack, NY
 - Time: 20 Minutes
 - Distance: 8.7 Miles
 - Hours: Sunday – Thursday – 11:00 AM – 12:00 AM Friday – 11:00 AM – 1:00 AM
 - Phone: 845-353-5515

Family and Indoor Entertainment

- Kids Empire**
 - Address: 33 Spring Valley Market Pl, Spring Valley, NY
 - Time: 13 Minutes
 - Hours: Monday – Thursday: 10:00 AM – 8:00 PM
 - Friday – Sunday: 10:00 AM – 10:00 PM
 - Phone: 845-414-3142
 - Distance: 3 Miles

American Dream Mall

- Nickelodeon Universe Theme Park**
 - Address: 1 American Dream Wy, East Rutherford, NJ
 - Time: 40 Minutes
 - Distance: 25 Miles
 - Hours: Monday – Friday - 10:00 AM – 9:00 PM Sunday – 11:00 AM – 7:00 PM
 - Phone: 833-263-7326
- 2. Big SNOW American Dream**
 - Address: 1 American Dream Wy, East Rutherford, NJ
 - Hours: Sunday – 10:00 AM – 8:00 PM Monday – Thursday – 1:00 PM – 8:00 PM
 - Friday – 1:00 PM – 9:00 PM
 - Phone: 973-864-6600
- SEA LIFE New Jersey Aquarium**
 - Address: 1 American Dream Wy Suite A, East Rutherford, NJ
 - Hours: Sunday - 10:00 AM – 7:00 PM
 - Monday – Tuesday - 10:00 AM – 8:00 PM
 - Wednesday – Friday - 10:00 AM – 6:30 PM
 - Phone: 551-234-6382
- Dream Wheel NJ Observation Wheel Attraction**
 - Address: 1 American Dream Wy Suite A, East Rutherford, NJ
 - Time: 40 Minutes
 - Distance: 25 Miles
 - Hours: Sunday: 11:00 AM – 8:00 PM Monday – Thursday: 12:00 PM – 9:00 PM
 - Friday: 12:00 PM – 10:00 PM
 - Phone: 301-455-8899

CURRENT JEWISH NEWS

By: Elimelech Grossberger

The “Big Reveal” in YerushalayimAs families prepare for the Seder, archaeologists in Jerusalem have just finished re-inaugurating the Ancient Pilgrimage Road. This is the actual street that our ancestors walked on when they traveled to the Beis HaMikdash for the Shalosh Regalim.

• The Discovery: They also recently found a monumental 40-foot-high dam wall at the Nisuch Hamayim dating back to the time of the Kings of Yehuda.

• Why it matters: It’s a literal bridge to the past, making the “Next year in Yerushalayim” prayer feel more real than ever.

“Shul Runnings”: Israel Hits the Ice The 2026 Winter Olympics in Milan just wrapped up, and Team Israel made history.

• The Bobsled Debut: For the first time ever, Israel sent a bobsled team to the Olympics. Led by A.J. Edelman, the team dubbed themselves the “Shul Runnings”.

• Jewish Stars: From the U.S. team’s Jewish hockey stars (the Hughes brothers) to Israel’s first-ever Olympic cross-country skier, Attila Mihály Kertész, there was plenty to cheer for during the winter months leading up to Nissan.

AI Joins the Seder? Artificial Intelligence is changing how we learn Torah. A few weeks ago, the Orthodox Union launched a revolutionary AI-powered Torah app.

• The Tech: Some Jewish day schools are now using AI to let students’ “interview” historical figures like Eliyahu HaNavi or create AI-generated songs for Hallel.

The Debate: It sparked a huge conversation among teens: Does using AI to write a Dvar Torah count as “learning,” or is it just a shortcut?

INTERESTING FACTS ABOUT PESACH

By: Yitzy Friedman

Barack Obama in 2009 had a public Pesach seder. Abraham Lincoln was killed on the 4th night of Pesach.

The world’s largest Pesach seder was in Kathmandu, Nepal with over 1,000 people. The world’s largest matzah ball weighs 267 pounds.

COOL BY MISTAKE INVENTIONS

By: Chaim Singer

- Popsicles – A forgotten drink froze overnight with a stick in it.**
- Sticky Notes – A failed super-strong glue became perfect for reminders.**
- Microwave Oven – Chocolate melted in a pocket near radar tech... and voila! Fast cooking.**
- Potato Chips – Sliced too thin to annoy a customer, ended up crunchy and delicious.**
- Penicillin – Mold grew on bacteria and killed it, saving millions.**
- Velcro – Burrs stuck to clothes, inspiring hook-and-loop fasteners.**
- Corn Flakes – Leftover boiled wheat toasted into a crispy cereal hit.**
- Super Glue – A scientist spilled a sticky chemical and realized it glued everything instantly.**
- Chocolate Chip Cookies – A baker meant to make chocolate cookies but forgot to melt the chocolate; little chunks became a hit.**
- Slinky – A spring fell off a shelf and “walked” down by itself, inspiring the classic toy.**
- Teflon – A chemical experiment went wrong, but the slippery result became the non-stick pan coating we use today.**
- X-rays – Discovered when Wilhelm Röntgen noticed his hand glowed in front of a special tube by accident.**
- Pacemaker – Early experiments with the heart and electricity led to a device that keeps hearts beating steadily.**

DID YOU KNOW

By: Benny Kaplin

Space Edition

Did you know that the International Space Station is one of the brightest objects in the night sky and can often be seen without a telescope if you know when to look? It orbits Earth at an altitude of about 250 miles and moves at an incredible speed of roughly 17,500 miles per hour, fast enough to travel from New York to Los Angeles in just a few minutes. Because it’s constantly circling the planet, it completes a full orbit about every 90 minutes, which means astronauts on board experience around 16 sunrises and sunsets every single day. Inside the station, astronauts live and work in microgravity, which causes everything from floating water droplets to changes in how their muscles and bones behave over time. The station itself is about the size of a football field, with large solar panels that generate electricity, and it has been continuously inhabited by crews from around the world since the year 2000, making it one of the longest-running international scientific collaborations in history.

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